

The revelations by *Tehelka* have come at a wrong time. No doubt what happened in Gujarat in 2002 needs to be condemned, but the never-ending politicisation of the issue does not augur well for the state's future.

ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

By carrying out a sting operation when Gujarat is going to polls, *Tehelka* has erred in its judgement. This is something unbecoming for a magazine of its repute. It was not the first time that communal riots had taken place in the country. Such sting operations are losing credibility and becoming tools for personal vendetta.

MAHESH KUMAR, *Delhi*

Power Play

It's a pity that a former prime minister is busy playing politics of opportunism rather than of idealism ("Remarriage After Divorce", November 12). It is time the political bosses stopped dominating the MLAs and allowed them to install a chief minister of their choice.

SUBHASH C. AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

MLAs are elected representatives whose primary job is to enact laws in people's interests. But it is a pity that they are no better than a herd of cattle for their leaders to be paraded before everyone in the quest for power.

J.S. ACHARYA, *Hyderabad*

Considering the tantrums JD(S) throws at regular intervals, the common man can never be sure how long the new Government will last. However, it is expected

that BJP will demonstrate its administrative acumen and provide clean governance to the state.

J.N. MAHANTY, *Puri*

Don't Malign God

It is a rigid interpretation of Islam which has Talibanised Pakistani society ("Rising Talibanisation", November 5). A reinterpretation of the religion may reverse the process. Islam must be liberated from the politics it has come to be associated

with, so that it becomes a religion of peace.

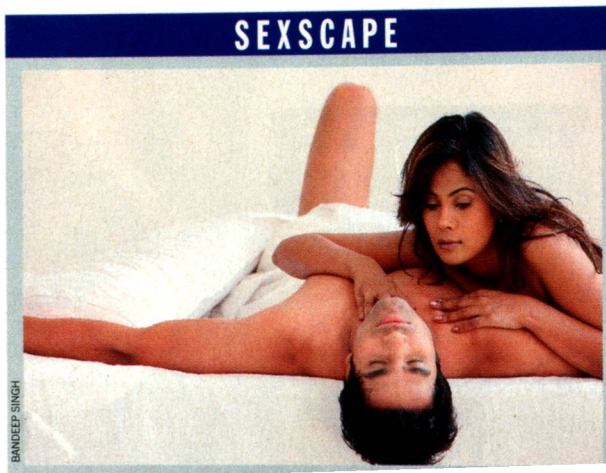
PARJAN KUMAR JAIN, *Delhi*

Armed Trouble

Most army officers are adept at siphoning off government money ("Rot at the Top", October 29). Soldiers are forced to dedicate their services to them and their families instead of the nation. The government must ensure that officers do not misuse their power.

SURENDRA K. PANDEY,

Bhujpur, Bihar



One does not doubt the sincerity of the magazine in trying to address the issues of love, marriage and sex ("Sex and Marriage", November 5). However, the postures, poses and vividness in the pictures did not go with the essence of the write-ups.

AUGUSTINE JOSEPH, *Bangalore*

Active sex—as is evident in the survey—has become directly proportional to the longevity of marriage in the country's urban milieu. The key to a successful marriage is both men and women trying to understand and fulfil each other's sexual desires.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

The overall impression of the survey is that the country is still in the comfort zone where conjugal values, for which it is rightly admired, are largely intact.

H.R. BAPU SATYANRAYANA, *Mysore*

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Years Ago in India Today

DECEMBER 1-15, 1977



Lamb in Lion's Guise

The taxi driver in Srinagar was happy to offer his own assessment of the current political climate. "Everybody calls Sheikh Abdullah the Lion of Kashmir. But actually he is a lamb at heart," he said. Pressed a little further, he summed up the situation, "This Ordinance is not a good thing. It will not solve anybody's problem." He was, of course,

talking about Sheikh the recent Ordinance promulgated by Governor L.K. Jha. Under this law, the Sheikh "in the interest of the security of the state and maintenance of public order", can arrest or detain anyone for "prejudicial activity" without giving any reason. For more than four decades now, Kashmiris have depended on a single person to champion their cause—Sheikh Abdullah. If the summer of 1977 in Kashmir was overcome by the sound of thunderous applause at his comeback, the autumn has been considerably subdued.

—Sunil Sethi